Optical mouse

A computer mouse allows you to move a pointer on the computer's monitor so that you can interact with documents and programs. Most computer mice are optical devices: they have a light inside that illuminates the surface below it and a tiny camera that creates an image of the surface. Circuits inside analyze the image and work out in which direction the mouse is moving, and how fast, and send that information to the computer.

COMMON CONNECTIONS

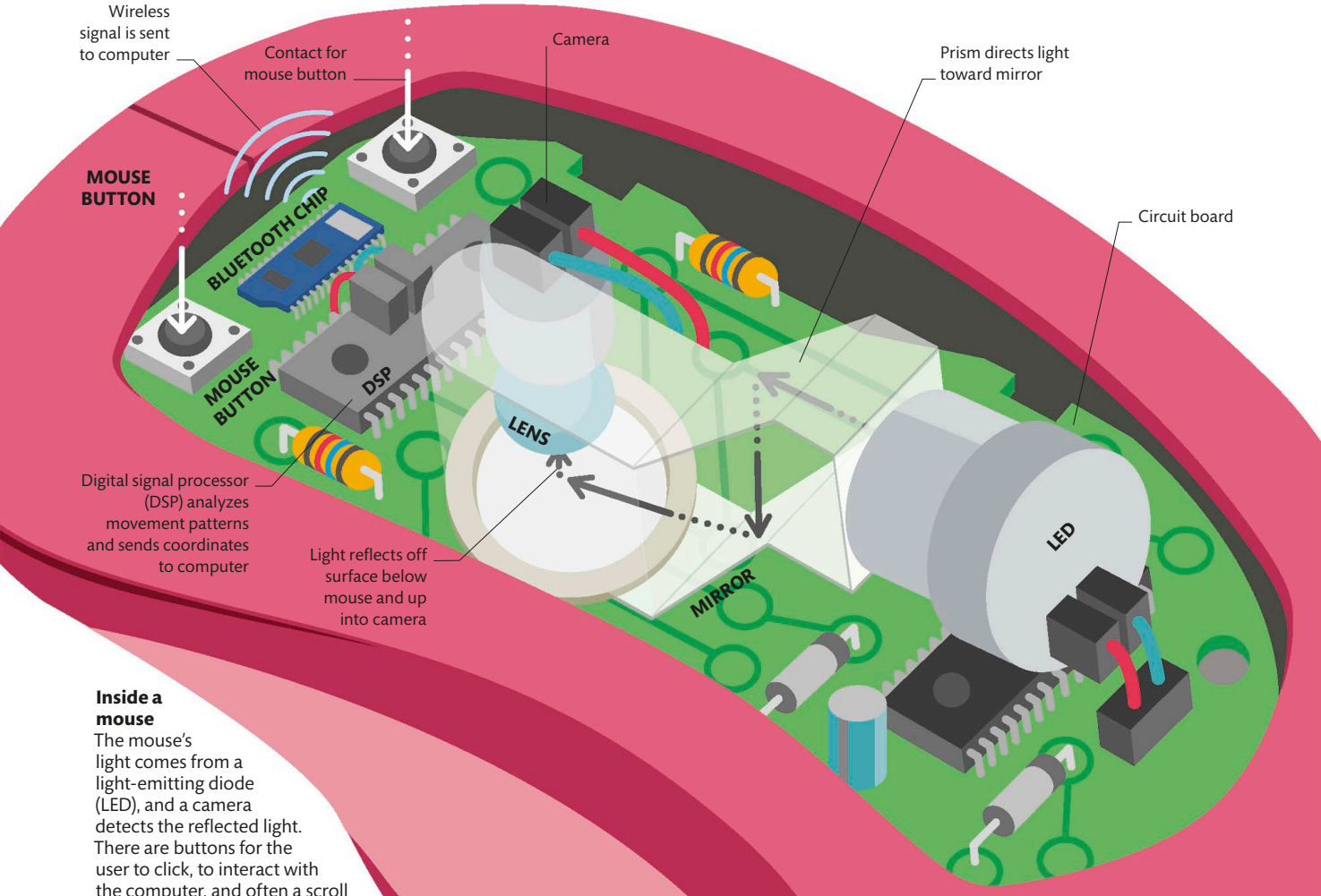
Mice and keyboards can be connected to a computer with cables or may be connected wirelessly, in which case information is coded into radio waves. The most common kind of wireless mouse uses Bluetooth technology.

Radio
Information travels via radio waves from an onboard transmitter to a receiver plugged into a USB port.

USB
Some mice and keyboards simply plug into the computer via a cable with a USB connector at the end.

Bluetooth
Information is sent from a cordless mouse or keyboard to a computer. This technology uses little power.

Built-in
Laptops have built-in keyboards and touch-sensitive touchpads, although external mice can be connected.



Inside a mouse
The mouse's light comes from a light-emitting diode (LED), and a camera detects the reflected light. There are buttons for the user to click, to interact with the computer, and often a scroll wheel to scroll through documents.